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CC 303

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Mythical Landmarks Final Project Commentary

My final project is a dashboard of visuals about the connections between mythological figures and their relevant locations in the Odyssey. Originally, I wanted to present this in the form of a website, using images and writing. I had, and still do have, an enjoyment for building websites. However, I took the project in a slightly different direction after going through most of my Data Visualizations computer science course. The course centered around using datasets to make visuals that portrayed some insight. I decided that I would use my experience from the course and apply it to this project.

First, I made my own dataset, which is key for creating good visuals. I collected the mythological figures, locations they visited, citations from the Odyssey, and descriptions of the citations/moments. I also noted whether those locations were mythological locations or physical locations. I focused on Odysseus because he is the main character and I wanted to make an animated route of his journey. I collected the order of the locations(stops) of him in the dataset. I ended up with 14 characters total, though many only have one location because they don't travel much, so they are on the dataset to contribute to the overall map of characters.

With much more time, I would have liked to have a much larger dataset, containing every single character and location they have gone to. This would allow me to make more in depth visuals, and also allow me to come up with a research question that could be answered with prediction models. I decided not to include prediction models in this project because I only have

34 rows of data, which is good for creating some visuals, but for a prediction model you would preferably have hundreds to thousands of rows of data for it to work effectively.

There are interesting connections to take away from some visuals. You can clearly see Odysseus' journey, connections between characters and locations, see where every character was most prominent, and see what locations were real vs mythical. I think it effectively met my goal of transforming the Odyssey into a visual format in order to visualize mythology in an informative yet fun way.